



towers, which presently consume diesel in sizeable volumes.

Against the backdrop of growing import dependence and difficulty in making structural changes overnight, the Indian economy is facing friction points—as is evident from the recent GDP growth numbers—and the energy scenario is going through hardships in righteous expansion drive. This is bringing in more stress to the energy ecosystem, as it's putting great burden on the foreign exchange exchequer through import bills, and posing challenges in terms of low investments in the energy sector. Also, it affects the commitment towards providing uninterrupted power supply and adequate subsidies to the agricultural and farm sectors—the economy drivers of India.

These and many others factors in terms of economic stress in the category have catapulted the government to create the Energy Security Group 2047, with the principal aim of steering India towards energy efficiency, sustainable growth and uninterrupted power supply. The group shall also envisage policy, finance and technology considerations.

Enhancing energy security of the country seems to be the single most important objective of the national energy strategy. This calls for a multi-pronged strategy both around energy demand and supply, along with multiple facets of energy policy including pricing, regulation, distribution and an overseas strategy to obtain secure energy supplies at stable prices. Technology is also a vital input, particularly in energy

efficiency. Therefore India's energy strategy would necessarily comprise action on both demand and supply sides with due consideration to policy, finance and technology.

Moving beyond megawatts to gigawatts

To make our prime minister's vision of sustainable growth a success, we need to collectively take some steps in terms of Green Growth, which means accepting RE forms as a part of life. Can we look at creating new Hybrid Parks in cities and towns, which harness both solar and wind energy together to drive maximum output? And options to reach out and put up solar panels at homes and offices? And putting up more and more solar panels over water bodies to minimise surface evaporation? The first step towards growth is to change ourselves towards acceptability!

As I sign off, I shall not leave you with a question but a thought: This Diwali (the festival of lights), can you drive change by lighting a poor family's home with renewable energy? Can you bring light in people's lives?

Shall wait to hear from you on your plans and how many did you impact!

To connect with me, please feel free to write a message at editsec@efy.in; I shall be happy to interact further.

By Sanjay Banerjee

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